me Valley. When the local authorities found him suspiciously marching along counting his steps and entering numbers in a book, they promptly sent him back the way he had come. Having made friends with the Tibetan officials, Morshead instinctively decided to not only come clean about his task, but also to demonstrate the use of his instruments to the local authorities. This policy of absolute openness worked wonderfully well, for from that point onwards, all physical readings of the terrain could be taken with pinpoint accuracy and with plenty of willing helpers assisting in the task.

Despite the bonhomie with the local administration, permission to traverse the length of the Tsangpo to its source was refused. So the party left Showa on 28 June and in a couple of days reached the twin villages of Tang tó and Tang me. Most rope bridges having been destroyed by the retreating Chinese, they had to take a diversion to cross the Yigrong Tso by ferry, eventually reaching Trulung on 9 July.

At Trulung, the dzongpen of Tse-la and other officials, who had hurried to Pe on hearing of the arrival of strangers, issued the party with passports that allowed them to enter Inner Tibet. The incredible journey that would directly influence events half a century later continued. From Trulung, the survey party followed the Tibet Road along the Rong Chu via Tongkuk Dzong and the Nyima-la to Pe. The party then moved along the right bank of the Tsangpo to Gyála, where it formally entered Tibet.

The two British officers were determined to survey as much of the Tsangpo as they could. This meant they would have to head east for a while; in the end the survey party could not actually make it to the great bend itself, but they were able to more or less establish the entire course of the Tsangpo.

While returning to Gyála the weather became bright and sunny allowing Morshead to interpolate not just the Namcha Barwa but also some of the triangulated peaks across the river that culminated in the Gyála Peri. By the end of August the party had reached Tsetang, a town of some 300 houses that included a colony of Kashmiri traders from whom they procured critical provisions. From Tsetang they left the Tsangpo and entered Chumda Kyang. They were now in the typical elevated plateau country of Tibet, far above the level of trees or fuel, where in winter no crop would ripen other than a little stunted barley. Villages were few and squalid, and the